Ford Motor Company

A.R. O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs
48121
Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan

April 2001

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Owner Notification Program 01B72: Certain 1999 and 2000 Model Year Ranger-EV – Rear Axle Spring Bolts - Torque Check

OASIS: Yes
OWNER LIST: Yes
PARTS RETURN: No
PROGRAM TERMS: This program will be in effect until November 30, 2001, regardless of mileage. (After this program expires, the vehicle may still be eligible for this service under any remaining vehicle warranty coverage).

AFFECTED VEHICLES

- Certain 1999 model year Ranger-EV vehicles built at the Edison Assembly Plant from May 6, 1998 through August 2, 1999
- Certain 2000 model year Ranger-EV vehicles built at the Edison Assembly Plant from August 17, 1999 through July 25, 2000

REASON FOR PROGRAM

In some of the affected vehicles, the rear leaf spring assemblies were not 'pre-flattened' during the build process of the spring to the knuckle. This improper assembly process may result in the loss of spring cap fastener torque and, in some cases, may cause a visible 'gap' at the seam between the spring cap and the knuckle. A loss of spring cap bolt torque will increase the rear suspension compliance and give the driver a 'sense of looseness' in the rear axle.

SERVICE ACTION

Authorized EV-dealers must inspect all of the affected vehicles for the presence of a 'gap' at the seam between the rear axle knuckles and the spring caps. This inspection will determine one of two repair actions:

- No gap – Tighten spring cap bolts to specification
- Gap exists – Perform axle wedge adjustment and tighten spring cap bolts to specification

In both cases, before **any** adjustments are made, it will be necessary to install two (2) special spring adjusting tools that were shipped to EV-dealers during the month of March. These tools *must remain in place on both springs* until all tightening and adjustments are performed. Refer to Attachment III for detailed instructions.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I:	Administrative Information
Attachment II:	Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III:	Technical Information
Owner Notification Letter	

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……1-800-423-8851
Other Program Questions:……..1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Owner Notification Program 01B72
Certain 1999 and 2000 Model Year Ranger-EV
Rear Axle Spring Bolt -Torque Check

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this program.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Recall/ONP Involved Unit Listings available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

Program Code:	01B72
Misc. Expense:	REFUND
Misc. Expense:	ADMIN
Misc. Expense:	0.2 Hr.

Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle, except for fuel which will be at owner's expense. The authorized maximum rental period is four days. Follow Extended Service Plan (ESP) guidelines for rental dollar amounts. Enter the word "RENTAL" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area.

Owner Notification Program 01B72
Certain 1999 and 2000 Model Year Ranger-EV
Rear Axle Spring Bolt -Torque Check

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspect – NO 'gap' -- Tighten Rear Axle Spring Cap Bolts to Specification, BOTH SIDES	01B72B	0.9 Hours
Inspect – "Gap Exists" – Perform Axle Wedge Adjustment ONE SIDE and Tighten Rear Axle Cap Bolts (Both Sides)	01B72C	1.0 Hours
Inspect – "Gap Exists" – Perform Axle Wedge Adjustment BOTH SIDES and Tighten Rear Axle Cap Bolts – (Both sides)	01B72D	1.2 Hours

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

There are no parts required for this program. However, a special set of 'spring adjusting tools' is required to complete the repair. These tools were shipped to all authorized Ranger-EV dealers during the early part of March 2001. If a dealer has not received these tools, please call the Special Service Support Center at 1-800-325-5621.

Ford Motor Company

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Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
www.ownerconnection.com

May 2001

01B72

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

Ford Motor Company is providing four no-charge service programs to owners of certain 1999 and 2000 model year Ranger-EV vehicles.

Reason For These Programs …

The purpose of these programs is to enhance the long-term customer satisfaction with your Ranger EV.

The first program, 01B69 – Your vehicle may have an electric coolant pump that could malfunction under certain duty cycles. If the pump malfunctions, the coolant temperature will increase as indicated by the temperature gauge and the red "power limit" light will illuminate, indicating that available vehicle power is being reduced. Within one minute, the "power limit" lamp will begin flashing, indicating that available vehicle power is being further reduced. Continued driving will result in vehicle shutdown.

The second program, 01B70 – An intermittent illumination of the oil light could occur, which indicates that the oil pressure is below minimum requirements. This could result in reduced vehicle performance (15-25 MPH maximum speed).

The third program, 01B72 – The rear axle to spring attachment in your vehicle may have been assembled improperly. This condition, if not corrected, could lead to loosening of the fasteners, which could give you a 'sense of looseness' in the rear axle area.

The fourth program, 01B76 – Ford Motor Company has determined that Battery Controller software version 3.3.1 will provide optimum vehicle range and battery life. Your vehicle should be updated to this level to take advantage of these improvements.

What *Ford Motor Company* and your dealer will do…

Program 01B69 – Dealers will perform a test to determine if the electric coolant pump is near the end of its useful life, and will replace those pumps that fail this test.

Program 01B70 – Dealers will update the software of the Traction Inverter Module (TIM) to eliminate the possibility of reduced vehicle performance.

Program 01B72 – Dealers will inspect the rear axle spring attachment. If the attachment is not properly assembled, dealers will correct it.

Program 01B76 – Dealers will update the Battery Control Module software to the version 3.3.1 level.

These programs will be in effect until November 30, 2001, regardless of mileage. (After this program expires, the vehicle may still be eligible for this service under any remaining vehicle warranty coverage).

What we are asking you to do…

Call your dealer without delay. Provide the dealer with your Vehicle Identification Number (located at the beginning of this letter). Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Owner Notification Program 01B69 (no parts are required for 01B70, 01B72, 01B76).

If your dealer does not have the parts in stock, they can be ordered before scheduling your service date. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering.

How long will it take…

The time needed for these repairs is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time. Please call your dealer for a service date.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

Refund…

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford Motor Company is offering a refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us so we can update our records. If you have sold the vehicle, the information you provide on the postcard will be used to notify the new owner about this program.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager for assistance.

If you still have concerns, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

Call (866) 436-7332 …

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8AM – 11PM
Saturday: 9AM – 6PM

Hearing impaired, call (800) 232-5952…

Or you may contact us through the Internet …

www.ownerconnection.com

Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

Quality Care service is there for you all year long.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Again, we are sorry for the inconvenience. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs